VIET CONG KIT

The essence of the Viet Cong's strategy was to blend in with the civilian population, so the basic uniform consisted of a pair of black cotton pyjamas, a black floppy hat, and a scarf. This outfit allowed their members, both male and female, to pass for local villagers. When on active operations they made skilful use of jungle camouflage, American parachutes providing a valuable source of material for shawls and helmet covers.

Camouflage hat
The Viet Cong usually wore black cotton hats to match their clothes or the conical straw hats worn by local farmers. In combat, however, they might exchange these for camouflaged pith helmets or hats like this, similar to those worn by American troops.

Tube tied with scrap of cloth

Rice tube
The Viet Cong used a simple yet practical method of carrying provisions for their units – a long canvas tube filled with rice that was slung round the neck like a bandolier.

Male tunic
Both male and female guerrillas wore very similar black clothing, but the stitching on the tunics worn by women was slightly different.

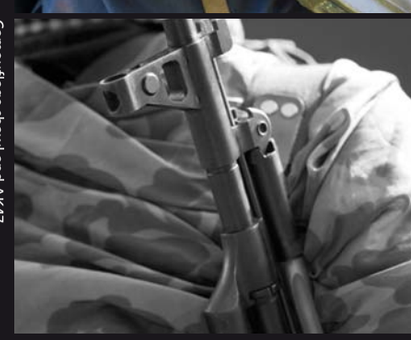
> "TWO PAIRS OF BLACK PYJAMAS, A COUPLE OF PAIRS OF UNDERPANTS, A MOSQUITO NET AND A FEW SQUARE YARDS OF LIGHT NYLON … WERE ALL THAT A GUERRILLA OWNED."
>
> **TRUONG NHU TANG** *A VIET CONG MEMOIR*

Canvas cover

Lightweight shovel
Digging played an important part in the Viet Cong guerrilla campaigns. As well as the famous underground tunnel systems that allowed them to move unseen through the jungle, they also constructed well camouflaged bunkers and strongpoints.



Carrying a captured American light antitank weapon



Camouflage shawl and AK47